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Xiǎnyáng Shèngjiào Lùn (Compendium of the Ascertainment of the Noble Teaching)

顯揚聖教論

Taishō Tripiṭaka No. 1602, 20 fascicles

By Asaṅga (無著菩薩). Translated from the Sanskrit by Xuánzàng (玄奘), Tang dynasty.

Fascicle 1

Chapter 1: Compendium of Topics (*Shè Shì Pǐn* 攝事品, Part 1)

> The Bhagavān's teachings include all dharmas. To clarify the noble teaching, this treatise is composed.

The treatise states: In brief, there are nine topics. What are the nine? (1) The five dharmas, (2) realms, (3) defilements, (4) truths, (5) meditative bases, (6) awakening factors, (7) persons, (8) fruits, and (9) virtues.

1. The Five Dharmas

(a) Mind (*citta*) **Question:** What is mind?

Answer: Mind is threefold: mind (*citta*), mentation (*manas*), and consciousness (*vijñāna*).

The first, mind (*citta*), is also called the *ālaya-vijñāna* (storehouse consciousness), also called the *ādāna-vijñāna* (appropriating consciousness). Why is it called mind (*citta*)? Because it is the accumulation (*cita*) and heaping up of seeds of all dharmas. Why is it called the *ālaya-vijñāna*? Because it takes hold of and stores the body with its sense-faculties, so that they are not lost, and because they mutually take hold of one another as appropriating consciousness.

The second, mentation (*manas*), is also called the afflicted mentation (*kliṣṭa-manas*). Why is it called mentation? Because it always takes the *ālaya-vijñāna* as its object and engages with the mental activities of self-view (*ātma-dṛṣṭi*), self-conceit (*ātma-māna*), self-love (*ātma-sneha*), and ignorance (*avidyā*), and is constantly conjoined with these four afflictions.

The third, consciousness (*vijñāna*), is also called the discriminating consciousness. It comprises the six consciousnesses: eye-consciousness, ear-consciousness, nose-consciousness, tongue-consciousness, body-consciousness, and mental consciousness (*mano-vijñāna*). Because they understand and discriminate their respective objects, they are called consciousnesses.

As the verse says:

> Mind, also called the *ālaya*, Together with mentation and the consciousness, The five [sense-consciousnesses] and the mental consciousness: These are designated ”mind” in summary.

(b) Mental Factors (*caitta* / *caitasika*) **Question:** What are mental factors?

Answer: In brief, mental factors are of fifty-one kinds, organized into six categories.

i. Five Omnipresent Factors (*sarva-traga*):

1. Attention (*manaskāra*): the function of directing the mind toward an object.
2. Contact (*sparśa*): the conjunction of sense-faculty, object, and consciousness, which serves as the basis for feeling.
3. Feeling (*vedanā*): the experience of pleasant, unpleasant, or neutral sensation.
4. Perception (*saṃjñā*): the apprehension of distinguishing characteristics.

5. Volition (*cetanā*): the function of the mind that moves the mental continuum toward good, evil, or neutral activity.

ii. Five Object-Determining Factors (*viniyata*):

1. Aspiration (*chanda*): the desire to act regarding a perceived object.
2. Resolve (*adhimokṣa*): the decisive determination regarding that object.
3. Recollection (*smṛti*): the non-forgetfulness of a previously experienced object.
4. Concentration (*samādhi*): one-pointed focus of the mind on its object.
5. Wisdom (*prajñā*): the discernment of dharmas, the function of investigating and distinguishing.

iii. Eleven Wholesome Factors (*kuśala*):

1. Faith (*śraddhā*), 2. Diligence (*vīrya*), 3. Shame (*hrī*), 4. Decorum (*apatrāpya*), 5. Non-greed (*alobha*), 6. Non-hatred (*adveṣa*), 7. Non-delusion (*amoha*), 8. Tranquility (*praśrabdhi*), 9. Heedfulness (*apramāda*), 10. Equanimity (*upekṣā*), 11. Non-harmfulness (*ahiṃsā*).

iv. Six Root Afflictions (*mūla-kleśa*):

1. Craving (*rāga*), 2. Aversion (*pratigha*), 3. Ignorance (*avidyā*), 4. Conceit (*māna*), 5. Doubt (*vicikitsā*), 6. Wrong view (*dṛṣṭi*).

Wrong view is fivefold: (a) view of the self-collection (*satkāya-dṛṣṭi*), (b) extreme view (*antagrāha-dṛṣṭi*), (c) wrong view (*mithyā-dṛṣṭi*), (d) clinging to views (*dṛṣṭi-parāmarśa*), (e) clinging to rules and observances (*śīla-vrata-parāmarśa*).

v. Twenty Secondary Afflictions (*upakleśa*):

1. Wrath (*krodha*), 2. Enmity (*upanāha*), 3. Dissimulation (*mrakṣa*), 4. Vexation (*pradāśa*), 5. Jealousy (*īrṣyā*), 6. Miserliness (*mātsarya*), 7. Deceit (*māyā*), 8. Guile (*śāṭhya*), 9. Arrogance (*mada*), 10. Harmfulness (*vihiṃsā*), 11. Shamelessness (*āhrīkya*), 12. Lack of decorum (*anapatrāpya*), 13. Torpor (*styāna*), 14. Restlessness (*auddhatya*), 15. Non-faith (*āśraddhya*), 16. Laziness (*kausīdya*), 17. Heedlessness (*pramāda*), 18. Forgetfulness (*muṣita-smṛtitā*), 19. Distraction (*vikṣepa*), 20. Non-discernment (*asaṃprajanya*).

vi. Four Indeterminate Factors (*aniyata*):

1. Regret (*kaukṛtya*), 2. Drowsiness (*middha*), 3. Applied thought (*vitarka*), 4. Sustained thought (*vicāra*).

(c) Form (*rūpa*) **Question:** What is form?

Answer: In brief, form is of fifteen kinds. As the verse says:

> The five sense-organs, five sense-objects, and unmanifest form: The material aggregates have fifteen kinds.

The five sense-organs are eye, ear, nose, tongue, and body. The five sense-objects are form, sound, smell, taste, and tangibles. Further, there is form pertaining to the mind-base (*dharma-āyatana-paryāpanna-rūpa*), also called unmanifest form (*avijñapti-rūpa*).

(d) Formations Not Associated with Mind (*citta-viprayukta-saṃskāra*) **Question:** What are formations not associated with mind?

Answer: In brief, they are of twenty-four kinds: (1) acquisition (*prāpti*), (2) non-acquisition, (3) homogeneous nature of the group (*nikāya-sabhāga*), (4) the state of being without thought (*āsaṃjñika*), (5) the attainment of the thoughtless absorption, (6) the attainment of cessation (*nirodha-samāpatti*), (7) life-force (*jīvitendriya*), (8) arising (*jāti*), (9) aging (*jarā*), (10) duration (*sthiti*), (11) impermanence (*anityatā*), (12) collections of names (*nāma-kāya*), (13) collections of phrases (*pada-kāya*), (14) collections of syllables (*vyañjana-kāya*), (15) the state of being an ordinary person (*pṛthagjana-tva*), (16) continuity (*pravṛtti*), (17) distinction (*pratiniyama*), (18) conjunction (*yoga*), (19) rapidity (*jāva*), (20) sequence (*anukrama*), (21) time (*kāla*), (22) region (*deśa*), (23) number (*saṃkhyā*), (24) combination (*sāmagrī*).

(e) Unconditioned Dharmas (*asaṃskṛta*) **Question:** What are unconditioned dharmas?

Answer: In brief, they are of eight kinds: (1) space (*ākāśa*), (2) non-analytical cessation (*apratisaṃkhyā-nirodha*), (3) analytical cessation (*pratisaṃkhyā-nirodha*), (4) cessation of suffering and pleasure (*vedanā-nirodha*), (5) cessation of perception and feeling (*saṃjñā-vedayita-nirodha*), (6) immobile cessation (*āniñjya*), (7) suchness (*tathatā*), (8) the dharma-realm (*dharma-dhātu*).

2. Realms (*dhātu*) **Question:** What are the realms?

Answer: In brief, there are three realms: the desire realm (*kāma-dhātu*), the form realm (*rūpa-dhātu*), and the formless realm (*ārūpya-dhātu*). There are five destinies (*gati*): hells (*naraka*), animals (*tiryañc*), hungry ghosts (*preta*), humans (*manuṣya*), and gods (*deva*). There are four modes of birth (*yoni*): egg-born (*aṇḍaja*), womb-born (*jarāyuja*), moisture-born (*saṃsvedaja*), and spontaneously born (*upapāduka*).

As the verse says:

> Three realms, five destinies, and four modes of birth: These are the distinctions of the realm of sentient beings.

3. Defilements (*saṃkleśa*) **Question:** What are defilements?

Answer: In brief, there are three kinds of defilement: affliction-defilement (*kleśa-saṃkleśa*), karma-defilement (*karma-saṃkleśa*), and birth-defilement (*janma-saṃkleśa*).

Affliction-defilement includes the latent tendencies (*anuśaya*), the fetters (*saṃyojana*), the bonds (*bandhana*), the secondary afflictions (*upakleśa*), the entanglements (*paryavasthāna*), and the hindrances (*nīvaraṇa*). Afflictions are examined in terms of their nature, causes, objects, and functions.

Karma-defilement includes wholesome, unwholesome, and neutral actions of body, speech, and mind, both meritorious (*puṇya*) and non-meritorious (*apuṇya*), and the imperturbable (*āniñjya*) karma.

Birth-defilement is the process of becoming through the twelve links of dependent origination (*pratītya-samutpāda*): (1) ignorance, (2) formations, (3) consciousness, (4) name-and-form, (5) six sense-bases, (6) contact, (7) feeling, (8) craving, (9) grasping, (10) becoming, (11) birth, (12) old-age-and-death. These twelve links traverse three periods and two cycles of cause and effect, perpetuating the rounds of existence.

4. Truths (*satya*) **Question:** What are the truths?

Answer: In brief, there are four truths:

1. **Suffering (*duḥkha-satya*):** the three kinds of suffering are suffering of suffering (*duḥkha-duḥkhatā*), suffering of change (*vipariṇāma-duḥkhatā*), and suffering of conditioned existence (*saṃskāra-duḥkhatā*). All conditioned dharmas of the three realms are pervaded by suffering.

2. **Origination (*samudaya-satya*):** craving (*tṛṣṇā*) accompanied by delight and attachment, seeking pleasure here and there. It is the craving for sensual pleasures, craving for existence, and craving for non-existence.

3. **Cessation (*nirodha-satya*):** the complete cessation and exhaustion of that very craving, its abandonment, relinquishment, release, and non-attachment.

4. **The path (*mārga-satya*):** the noble eightfold path, namely: right view, right intention, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, and right concentration.

As the verse says:

> Suffering, its origination, cessation, and the path: These are the four noble truths as declared.

5. Meditative Bases (*samāhita-vastu*) **Question:** What are the meditative bases?

Answer: In brief, meditative bases include calm abiding (*śamatha*) and insight (*vipaśyanā*), the four meditative absorptions (*dhyāna*), the four formless attainments (*ārūpya-samāpatti*), the attainment of cessation of perception and feeling (*saṃjñā-vedayita-nirodha-samāpatti*), and the three concentrations (*samādhi*): emptiness (*śūnyatā*), signlessness (*ānimitta*), and wishlessness (*apraṇihita*).

The four absorptions are: (1) the first absorption, with applied and sustained thought, joy and pleasure born of seclusion; (2) the second absorption, with inner clarity, free from applied and sustained thought, joy and pleasure born of concentration; (3) the third absorption, with equanimity, mindfulness, and clear comprehension, pleasure experienced in the body; (4) the fourth absorption, with neither pleasure nor suffering, purity of equanimity and mindfulness.

The four formless attainments are: (1) the base of infinite space, (2) the base of infinite consciousness, (3) the base of nothingness, (4) the base of neither-perception-nor-non-perception.

6. Awakening Factors (*bodhipakṣya*) **Question:** What are the awakening factors?

Answer: In brief, the awakening factors include thirty-seven dharmas conducive to awakening (*saptatriṃśad-bodhipakṣya-dharmāḥ*):

- Four foundations of mindfulness (*smṛty-upasthāna*): mindfulness of body, feeling, mind, and dharmas.
- Four right exertions (*samyak-pradhāna*): preventing unarisen unwholesome dharmas, abandoning arisen unwholesome dharmas, generating unarisen wholesome dharmas, and maintaining arisen wholesome dharmas.
- Four bases of spiritual power (*ṛddhi-pāda*): aspiration, diligence, mind, and investigation.
- Five faculties (*indriya*): faith, diligence, mindfulness, concentration, and wisdom.
- Five powers (*bala*): [as above, but with the character of being unshakable].
- Seven factors of awakening (*bodhyaṅga*): mindfulness, investigation of dharmas, diligence, joy, tranquility, concentration, and equanimity.
- The noble eightfold path (*āryāṣṭāṅga-mārga*): [as listed above under truths].

Further, ten kinds of wisdom (*jñāna*), three gates of liberation (*vimokṣa-mukha*), four practices, four abodes (*vihāra*), four reliances (*pratisaraṇa*), and the bodhisattva practices including the ten grounds (*daśa-bhūmi*), the ten perfections (*daśa-pāramitā*), the four means of attraction (*catuḥ-saṃgraha-vastu*), *dhāraṇī* gates, and *samādhi* gates are all included.

The ten perfections are: (1) giving (*dāna*), (2) moral discipline (*śīla*), (3) patience (*kṣānti*), (4) diligence (*vīrya*), (5) meditative concentration (*dhyāna*), (6) wisdom (*prajñā*), (7) skillful means (*upāya*), (8) aspiration

(*praṇidhāna*), (9) power (*bala*), (10) knowledge (*jñāna*).

The ten grounds are: (1) Joyful (*pramuditā*), (2) Stainless (*vimalā*), (3) Luminous (*prabhākarī*), (4) Radiant (*arciṣmatī*), (5) Hard to Conquer (*sudurjayā*), (6) Facing Forward (*abhimukhī*), (7) Far-Reaching (*dūraṅgamā*), (8) Immovable (*acalā*), (9) Perfect Intellect (*sādhumatī*), (10) Cloud of Dharma (*dharma-meghā*).

7. Persons (*pudgala*) **Question:** What are persons?

Answer: In brief, there are two kinds of persons: those who have obtained the fruit and those who have not yet obtained the fruit. Those who have obtained the fruit include the four results: stream-enterer (*srotāpanna*), once-returner (*sakṛdāgāmin*), non-returner (*anāgāmin*), and worthy one (*arhat*). Also included are the three vehicle practitioners: śrāvaka, pratyekabuddha, and bodhisattva. Within the bodhisattva path, there are those on the grounds and those who have not yet entered the grounds.

8. Fruits (*phala*) **Question:** What are the fruits?

Answer: In brief, there are five fruits: (1) maturation fruit (*vipāka-phala*), (2) outflow fruit (*niṣyanda-phala*), (3) separation fruit (*visaṃyoga-phala*), (4) person-produced fruit (*puruṣakāra-phala*), and (5) dominant fruit (*adhipati-phala*).

9. Virtues (*guṇa*) **Question:** What are the virtues?

Answer: In brief, virtues include the thirty-two major marks (*dvātriṃśan-mahā-puruṣa-lakṣaṇa*) and eighty minor marks (*aśīty-anuvyañjana*) of a great being, the four kinds of purity, the ten powers (*daśa-bala*), the four fearlessnesses (*catvāri-vaiśāradyāni*), the three kinds of non-guardedness, the three foundations of mindfulness (*smṛty-upasthāna*), the destruction of habitual tendencies (*vāsanā*), never-forgetting dharma, great compassion (*mahā-karuṇā*), and the eighteen unshared dharmas of a buddha (*āveṇika-buddha-dharma*), culminating in omniscient wisdom (*sarvajña-jñāna*).

The ten powers are: (1) knowledge of what is possible and impossible, (2) knowledge of the maturation of karma, (3) knowledge of the various elements of sentient beings, (4) knowledge of the various dispositions, (5) knowledge of the superior and inferior faculties, (6) knowledge of the paths leading everywhere, (7) knowledge of the afflictions, purifications, and emergence regarding meditative absorptions, liberations, concentrations, and attainments, (8) knowledge of recollecting past lives, (9) knowledge of the death and rebirth of sentient beings, (10) knowledge of the destruction of defilements.

The four fearlessnesses are: (1) fearlessness in claiming perfect awakening, (2) fearlessness in claiming the destruction of all defilements, (3) fearlessness in declaring the obstacles to the path, (4) fearlessness in declaring the path leading to the end of suffering.

The eighteen unshared dharmas of a buddha include six aspects of unshared conduct, six aspects of unshared realization, and three aspects of unshared activity, plus the unshared wisdom that pervades the three times.

This concludes the summary of the nine topics as presented in the verse prologue and the opening section of the Compendium of Topics.

Fascicle 2

Chapter 1: Compendium of Topics (Continued, Part 2)

The Four Summaries of Buddha-word The treatise states: Now, the manner of understanding the Buddha's word will be explained. As the verse says:

> By means of four kinds of summary, The Buddha's word should be understood: Sentence-summary, meaning-summary, Setting-aside summary, and investigation-summary.

i. Sentence-summary (*pada-piṇḍārtha*): This concerns understanding the various types of statements made by the Bhagavān. The teaching is expressed through nine categories of literary form: sūtra, geya, vyākaraṇa, gāthā, udāna, nidāna, avadāna, itivṛttaka, and jātaka, as well as vaipulya, adbhuta-dharma, and upadeśa: twelve divisions of the teaching (*dvādaśāṅga-pravacana*) in all.

ii. Meaning-summary: This concerns four kinds of explanation of the hidden intent. The teaching is expressed through four modes: regarding the hidden intent of entry, regarding the hidden intent of characteristics, regarding the hidden intent of antidotes, and regarding the hidden intent of translation.

iii. Setting-aside summary: There are four things that should be set aside in order to understand the teaching correctly: (a) setting aside of the words alone, to penetrate the meaning; (b) setting aside of the meaning of mere convention, to penetrate the ultimate; (c) setting aside of the interpretable meaning, to penetrate the definitive meaning; (d) setting aside of reliance on ordinary consciousness, to rely on wisdom.

iv. Investigation-summary: The detailed investigation of all aspects of the teaching, including the analysis of delusion, conceptual elaboration, and the Buddha's intention.

Six Approaches to Proper Practice As the verse says:

> Hearing, thinking, cultivation: This is the foundation of the path. Calm and insight, the two wings: By these the practitioner proceeds.

The six approaches are: (1) listening to the correct dharma, (2) proper reflection, (3) cultivation of calm abiding (*śamatha*), (4) cultivation of insight (*vipaśyanā*), (5) correct practice, and (6) attainment of the fruit.

Fascicles 3–4

Chapter 1: Compendium of Topics (Continued, Parts 3–4)

These fascicles continue the detailed exposition of the nine topics, particularly elaborating on:

- The detailed sub-classifications of defilements, including the latent tendencies organized by the three realms and the three categories of objects to be abandoned by seeing, meditation, and neither.
- The detailed analysis of the twelve links of dependent origination, the forward and reverse sequences, and how they operate across three lifetimes.
- The detailed classification of the path structure, including the stages of accumulation (*saṃbhāra-mārga*), preparation (*prayoga-mārga*), seeing (*darśana-mārga*), cultivation (*bhāvanā-mārga*), and the path beyond training (*aśaikṣa-mārga*).
- The classification and distribution of the various types of persons according to their spiritual lineage (*gotra*), inclination, and capacity.

Fascicle 5

Chapter 2: Compendium of Pure Meaning (*Shè Jìng Yì Pǐn* 攝淨義品, Part 1)

The treatise states: Now the Compendium of Pure Meaning will be explained. As the verse says:

> The two truths, five dharmas, three natures, Twelve divisions of the teaching: These are the foundation of pure meaning, Taught for the welfare of sentient beings.

Two Truths **Question:** What are the two truths?

Answer: They are conventional truth (*saṃvṛti-satya*) and ultimate truth (*paramārtha-satya*). Conventional truth is the truth of worldly designation, the truth that accords with the understanding of ordinary beings regarding the names and characteristics of dharmas. Ultimate truth is the truth that is the object of the noble ones' direct realization, the true nature of dharmas as they really are.

Five Dharmas and Three Natures The five dharmas (*pañca-dharma*) are: (1) names (*nāma*), (2) characteristics (*nimitta*), (3) discrimination (*vikalpa*), (4) suchness (*tathatā*), (5) correct wisdom (*samyag-jñāna*).

The three natures (*trisvabhāva*) are:

1. **The imagined nature (*parikalpita-svabhāva*):** the nature that is merely imputed by conceptual elaboration. It is like seeing a rope as a snake. The imagined nature has no real existence; it is the object of erroneous discrimination.
2. **The dependent nature (*paratantra-svabhāva*):** the nature that arises dependently through causes and conditions. It is like the rope itself, which exists in dependence upon its component fibers and conditions. The dependent nature is the basis of both error and correct understanding.
3. **The thoroughly established nature (*pariniṣpanna-svabhāva*):** the absence of the imagined nature in the dependent nature. It is like correctly seeing the rope as a rope, or seeing its emptiness of snake-nature. The thoroughly established nature is suchness (*tathatā*), the object of non-discriminating wisdom.

Among the five dharmas, names and characteristics belong to the imagined nature; discrimination belongs to the dependent nature; suchness and correct wisdom belong to the thoroughly established nature.

The Twelve Divisions of the Teaching The twelve divisions (*dvādaśāṅga-dharma-pravacana*) are: sūtra, geya, vyākaraṇa, gāthā, udāna, nidāna, avadāna, itivṛttaka, jātaka, vaipulya, adbhuta-dharma, and upadeśa.

Hearing (*śruta*) **Question:** What is the meaning of hearing?

Answer: Hearing has six divisions: (1) hearing itself, (2) the function of hearing, (3) the characteristics of hearing, (4) the categories of hearing, (5) the relationship between hearing and practice, and (6) the accomplishment of hearing.

Hearing is the basis for all dharma practice. Without hearing the correct dharma, one cannot generate correct thinking; without correct thinking, one cannot cultivate the path; without cultivating the path, one cannot attain the fruit.

The Three Refuges (*triśaraṇa*) Taking refuge in the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṃgha has three divisions: (1) the nature of refuge, (2) the motive for taking refuge, and (3) the benefit of taking refuge.

The Three Trainings (*triśikṣā*) The three trainings are: (1) the higher training in moral discipline (*adhiśīla-śikṣā*), (2) the higher training in mind (*adhicitta-śikṣā*), and (3) the higher training in wisdom (*adhiprajñā-śikṣā*). These are elaborated in twelve divisions.

The Three Awakenings (*tribodhi*) The three awakenings are: (1) the awakening of the śrāvaka, (2) the awakening of the pratyekabuddha, and (3) the supreme perfect awakening (*anuttarā samyaksaṃbodhi*) of the buddha. These are distinguished in five divisions.

Fascicles 6–8

Chapter 2: Compendium of Pure Meaning (Continued, Parts 2–4)

Holy Conduct (*brahmacarya*) The treatise explains that holy conduct is the entirety of the path, including moral discipline, concentration, and wisdom. It is called ”holy” because it is the conduct of the noble ones and leads to the holy fruit.

The Great Vehicle (*mahāyāna*) **Question:** Why is the Mahāyāna called ”great”?

Answer: It is great in seven respects: (1) great object (*ālambana*), because it encompasses all dharmas; (2) great practice, because it includes all six perfections; (3) great wisdom, because it understands both person-selflessness and dharma-selflessness; (4) great diligence, because it spans three incalculable eons; (5) great skillful means, because it does not abandon sentient beings; (6) great accomplishment, because it achieves the ten powers and other virtues; (7) great activity, because it displays great miraculous powers.

The Great Awakening The supreme perfect awakening surpasses the awakenings of śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas because it abandons both the afflictive obstructions (*kleśa-āvaraṇa*) and the cognitive obstructions (*jñeya-āvaraṇa*), and because it is endowed with omniscient wisdom.

Virtues of Bodhisattvas The virtues of bodhisattvas are explained in terms of: (a) the initial generation of the aspiration for awakening (*bodhicitta-utpāda*), (b) the practice of the perfections, (c) the attainment of the grounds, and (d) the final attainment of buddhahood.

Fascicles 9–10

Chapter 2: Compendium of Pure Meaning (Continued, Parts 5–6)

Sixteen Heterodox Views and Their Refutation The treatise states: Now, the refutation of heterodox views will be explained. There are sixteen principal types of wrong view held by non-Buddhist philosophers:

1. The view of a permanent self (*ātman*).
2. The view that the world is eternal.
3. The view that the world is not eternal.
4. The view that the world is both eternal and not eternal.
5. The view that the world is neither eternal nor not eternal.
6. The view that the world has an end.
7. The view that the world has no end.

8. The view that the world both has and has no end.
9. The view that the world neither has nor has no end.
10. The view that the self and body are identical.
11. The view that the self and body are different.
12. The view that the Tathāgata exists after death.
13. The view that the Tathāgata does not exist after death.
14. The view that the Tathāgata both exists and does not exist after death.
15. The view that the Tathāgata neither exists nor does not exist after death.
16. The view that there is no causation.

Each of these views is refuted by showing its logical contradictions, its inconsistency with the directly perceived facts of impermanence and dependent origination, and its conflict with the Buddha's teaching.

Debate Methodology The treatise explains seven aspects of debate and argumentation:

1. **Thesis (*pratijñā*):** The proposition to be established.
2. **Reason (*hetu*):** The logical ground for the thesis.
3. **Example (*dṛṣṭānta*):** The illustration that supports the reason.
4. **Application (*upanaya*):** Applying the example to the case at hand.
5. **Conclusion (*nigamana*):** The final determination.
6. **Means of correct knowledge (*pramāṇa*):** Direct perception (*pratyakṣa*), inference (*anumāna*), and scriptural testimony (*āgama*).
7. **Fallacies (*hetvābhāsa*):** The various types of pseudo-reasons, including the unestablished, the contradictory, the inconclusive, and the counterbalanced.

Fascicles 11–13

Chapter 2: Compendium of Pure Meaning (Continued, Parts 7–9)

Hermeneutics and Interpretation The treatise explains the methods of interpreting the Buddha's teaching:

The four reliances (*catvāri pratisaraṇāni*): 1. Rely on the dharma, not on the person. 2. Rely on the meaning, not on the words. 3. Rely on the definitive meaning, not on the interpretable meaning. 4. Rely on wisdom, not on ordinary consciousness.

The interpretable and definitive meanings: Sūtras of interpretable meaning (*neyārtha*) require further explanation and should not be taken literally. Sūtras of definitive meaning (*nītārtha*) directly express the ultimate truth and can be taken as they stand.

The hidden intent (*abhiprāya*) of the teaching: The Buddha sometimes speaks with hidden intent for pedagogical purposes. Four types of hidden intent are distinguished: (1) intent regarding entry, (2) intent regarding characteristics, (3) intent regarding antidotes, (4) intent regarding translation from one mode of discourse to another.

Teacher Qualities The teacher of the dharma should possess the following qualities: learning, moral discipline, compassion, eloquence, patience, fearlessness, and skill in means.

Audience Types Audiences are classified according to their spiritual faculties, their lineage, and their capacity for receiving the teaching. The teacher should adapt the teaching according to the audience's capacity.

Praise of the Buddha The chapter concludes with an extensive praise of the Buddha's virtues, his compassion, his wisdom, and his unceasing activity for the benefit of sentient beings.

Fascicle 14

Chapter 3: Establishing Expertise (*Chéng Shànqiǎo Pǐn* 成善巧品)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of expertise will be explained. As the verse says:

> Seven kinds of expertise the wise should know: In aggregates, elements, sense-bases, Dependent origination, appropriate and inappropriate, Faculties, and the truths.

Question: How many kinds of expertise are there?

Answer: There are seven kinds of expertise (*saptavidha-kauśalya*):

1. **Expertise in the aggregates (*skandha-kauśalya*):** Understanding the five aggregates of form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness, their characteristics, arising, and cessation.
2. **Expertise in the elements (*dhātu-kauśalya*):** Understanding the eighteen elements, namely the six sense-organs, six sense-objects, and six sense-consciousnesses, and how they interact.
3. **Expertise in the sense-bases (*āyatana-kauśalya*):** Understanding the twelve sense-bases, namely the six internal bases (eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, mind) and six external bases (forms, sounds, smells, tastes, tangibles, dharmas).
4. **Expertise in dependent origination (*pratītya-samutpāda-kauśalya*):** Understanding the twelve links of dependent origination in both their forward and reverse sequences.
5. **Expertise in the appropriate and inappropriate (*sthānāsthāna-kauśalya*):** Understanding what is possible and impossible, what accords with the nature of dharmas and what does not.
6. **Expertise in the faculties (*indriya-kauśalya*):** Understanding the twenty-two faculties, including the five sense-faculties, the life-faculty, the five spiritual faculties, and others.
7. **Expertise in the truths (*satya-kauśalya*):** Understanding the four noble truths and the two truths (conventional and ultimate).

Each of these seven kinds of expertise is essential for the practitioner's progress on the path. They are the foundation for both calm abiding and insight, and for the direct realization of the nature of dharmas.

Chapter 4: Establishing Impermanence (*Chéng Wúcháng Pǐn* 成無常品)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of impermanence will be explained. As the verse says:

> All conditioned things are impermanent: This should be known through six types and eight.

Impermanence is of six types:

1. **Impermanence of arising and ceasing (*utpāda-vyaya-anityatā*):** All conditioned dharmas arise and cease in every moment.
2. **Impermanence as transformation (*anyathātva-anityatā*):** Conditioned dharmas continuously undergo change.

3. **Impermanence of destruction (*vināśa-anityatā*):** All conditioned dharmas eventually come to an end.
4. **Impermanence of separation (*viprayoga-anityatā*):** All associations eventually dissolve.
5. **Impermanence as momentariness (*kṣaṇika-anityatā*):** Dharmas exist only for a single moment.
6. **Impermanence of dharma-nature (*dharmatā-anityatā*):** It is simply the nature of conditioned dharmas to be impermanent.

The eight aspects elaborate on how impermanence manifests in the body, possessions, status, companions, moral character, views, prosperity, and life itself.

There are also fifteen kinds of change (*vipariṇāma*), and the chapter includes a detailed refutation of the eternalist position.

Fascicle 15

Chapter 5: Establishing Suffering (*Chéng Kŭ Pĭn* 成苦品)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of suffering will be explained. As the verse says:

> Three kinds of suffering pervade: Suffering of suffering, change, and formations.

The three kinds of suffering are:

1. **Suffering of suffering (*duḥkha-duḥkhatā*):** The direct experience of painful feeling.
2. **Suffering of change (*vipariṇāma-duḥkhatā*):** The suffering inherent in the fact that pleasant experiences come to an end.
3. **Suffering of conditioned existence (*saṃskāra-duḥkhatā*):** The suffering inherent in all conditioned phenomena, which are bound by impermanence and subject to the afflictions.

The chapter further enumerates fifty-five types of suffering in detail, organized according to: the suffering inherent in birth, aging, sickness, and death; the suffering of association with the unpleasant; the suffering of separation from the pleasant; the suffering of not obtaining what one desires; and the suffering of the five aggregates of clinging.

Chapter 6: Establishing Emptiness (*Chéng Kōng Pĭn* 成空品, Part 1)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of emptiness will be explained. As the verse says:

> Person-selflessness and dharma-selflessness: These two emptinesses should be understood.

Person-Selflessness (*pudgala-nairātmya*) Person-selflessness is established by showing that no permanent, unitary, independent self can be found among the five aggregates, either individually or collectively. The self is merely a conventional designation (*prajñapti*) based on the continuity of the aggregates.

Sixteen Emptinesses The sixteen kinds of emptiness are:

1. Internal emptiness (*ādhyātma-śūnyatā*)
2. External emptiness (*bahirdhā-śūnyatā*)
3. Internal-external emptiness (*ādhyātma-bahirdhā-śūnyatā*)
4. Emptiness of emptiness (*śūnyatā-śūnyatā*)
5. Great emptiness (*mahā-śūnyatā*)

6. Ultimate emptiness (*paramārtha-śūnyatā*)
7. Conditioned emptiness (*saṃskṛta-śūnyatā*)
8. Unconditioned emptiness (*asaṃskṛta-śūnyatā*)
9. Transcendent emptiness (*atyanta-śūnyatā*)
10. Beginningless emptiness (*anavarāgra-śūnyatā*)
11. Non-dispersal emptiness (*anavakāra-śūnyatā*)
12. Nature emptiness (*prakṛti-śūnyatā*)
13. All-dharma emptiness (*sarva-dharma-śūnyatā*)
14. Own-characteristic emptiness (*sva-lakṣaṇa-śūnyatā*)
15. Unobtainable emptiness (*anupalambha-śūnyatā*)
16. Non-entity own-nature emptiness (*abhāva-svabhāva-śūnyatā*)

Fascicle 16

Chapter 6: Establishing Emptiness (Continued, Part 2)

Eighteen Modes of Cultivating Emptiness The eighteen modes of cultivating emptiness encompass the progressive deepening of the understanding of emptiness through: (1) cultivating the emptiness of each aggregate, (2) cultivating the emptiness of each sense-base, (3) cultivating the emptiness of each element, (4) cultivating the emptiness of dependent origination, (5) cultivating the emptiness of the person, and so on, through increasingly subtle levels of analysis.

The chapter also discusses the relationship between emptiness and the three natures: the imagined nature is empty by nature, the dependent nature is empty of the imagined, and the thoroughly established nature is the emptiness of the imagined in the dependent.

Chapter 7: Establishing No-Self-Nature (*Chéng Wúxìng Pǐn* 成無性品)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of no-self-nature will be explained. As the verse says:

> Three no-self-natures are taught Based on the three natures of dharmas.

The three no-self-natures (*trividha-niḥsvabhāvatā*) are:

1. **No-self-nature of characteristics (*lakṣaṇa-niḥsvabhāvatā*):** The imagined nature (*parikalpita*) lacks self-nature because it is merely imputed by discrimination and does not exist by its own characteristics.

2. **No-self-nature of arising (*utpatti-niḥsvabhāvatā*):** The dependent nature (*paratantra*) lacks self-nature because it does not arise by its own power but only through the power of other conditions.

3. **Ultimate no-self-nature (*paramārtha-niḥsvabhāvatā*):** The thoroughly established nature (*pariniṣpanna*) is the ultimate no-self-nature, which is the object of the purified wisdom of the noble ones. It is the dharma-selflessness (*dharma-nairātmya*) of all dharmas.

Question: If all dharmas lack self-nature, how can the three natures be established?

Answer: Although all dharmas lack self-nature, this does not mean they are utterly non-existent. The three natures are established precisely through the three no-self-natures. The imagined nature does not exist but is imputed; the dependent nature exists as dependently arisen; the thoroughly established nature exists as the true nature of dharmas. Understanding this avoids both the extreme of eternalism and the extreme of nihilism.

Chapter 8: Establishing Direct Realization (*Chéng Xiànguān Pǐn* 成現觀品, Part 1)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of direct realization will be explained. As the verse says:

> Entry into the path of seeing: By direct realization, the truths are seen.

Direct realization (*abhisamaya*) is the direct, non-conceptual cognition of the four noble truths and the true nature of dharmas. It marks the transition from an ordinary being to a noble one (*ārya*).

Conditions for entry: To enter direct realization, one must: (1) have accumulated the requisites of merit and wisdom, (2) have completed the stages of accumulation and preparation, (3) have attained a sufficient degree of calm abiding and insight, and (4) have generated the correct understanding through hearing and reflection.

Ten kinds of certainty: The ten kinds of certainty (*daśa-niyata*) that accompany direct realization include certainty regarding the truths, certainty regarding the path, certainty regarding the fruit, and so forth.

Six and eighteen types of direct realization: Direct realization is classified into six types according to its object and eighteen types according to its mode.

Fascicle 17

Chapter 8: Establishing Direct Realization (Continued, Part 2)

The chapter continues with the detailed analysis of the stages of direct realization, including: the path of seeing (*darśana-mārga*), the path of cultivation (*bhāvanā-mārga*), the sixteen moments of the path of seeing, the progressive abandonment of the defilements, and the relationship between direct realization and the attainment of the four fruits.

Chapter 9: Establishing Yoga (*Chéng Yúqié Pǐn* 成瑜伽品)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of yoga will be explained. As the verse says:

> The yoga of the perfection of wisdom: Calm and insight in union.

Yoga here refers specifically to the yoga of *prajñāpāramitā*, the union of calm abiding (*śamatha*) and insight (*vipaśyanā*) directed toward the ultimate nature of dharmas. This is the supreme practice of the bodhisattva path.

The chapter explains: (1) the nature of this yoga, (2) its objects, (3) its practice, (4) its stages, and (5) its fruit. The yoga of *prajñāpāramitā* is distinguished from the yogas of the śrāvaka and pratyekabuddha paths by its scope (encompassing all dharmas and all sentient beings), its motivation (great compassion), and its fruit (omniscient wisdom).

Chapter 10: Establishing the Inconceivable (*Chéng Bùsīyì Pǐn* 成不思議品)

The treatise states: Now, the establishment of the inconceivable will be explained. As the verse says:

> Nine inconceivable matters: The wise should know them well.

The nine inconceivable matters are:

1. The inconceivable nature of the self (*ātman*): the true nature of the self is inconceivable.
2. The inconceivable nature of the world (*loka*): the extent and nature of the world are inconceivable.

3. The inconceivable nature of sentient beings (*sattva*): the variety of sentient beings' faculties and dispositions is inconceivable.
4. The inconceivable nature of the buddha-realm (*buddha-kṣetra*): the purification and adornment of buddha-lands are inconceivable.
5. The inconceivable nature of the maturation of karma (*karma-vipāka*): how actions produce their results is inconceivable in its full complexity.
6. The inconceivable nature of the power of meditation (*dhyāna-bala*): the powers gained through meditative attainment are inconceivable.
7. The inconceivable nature of the power of the Buddha (*buddha-bala*): the ten powers and other qualities of the Buddha are inconceivable.
8. The inconceivable nature of the power of the Dharma (*dharma-bala*): the transformative power of the teaching is inconceivable.
9. The inconceivable nature of the dharma-realm (*dharma-dhātu*): the ultimate nature of reality is inconceivable.

Chapter 11: Compendium of Supreme Determinations (*Shè Shèng Juézé Pǐn* 攝勝決擇品, Part 1)

The treatise states: Now, the Compendium of Supreme Determinations will be explained. As the verse says:

> Supreme determinations on the dharmas: Mind, form, and all the rest.

This chapter provides authoritative determinations (*nirṇaya*) on each of the topics previously discussed, going deeper into their analysis. It spans four fascicles (17 through 20) and constitutes the most detailed and analytically rigorous section of the treatise.

Supreme Determination on Mind The establishment of the *ālaya-vijñāna* through eight arguments:

The existence of the *ālaya-vijñāna* is established through eight lines of reasoning:

1. **From the impossibility of appropriation without it:** Without the *ālaya-vijñāna*, there would be no basis for the appropriation of a body endowed with sense-faculties. The six operative consciousnesses are intermittent and cannot serve as the continuous basis of appropriation.

2. **From the impossibility of sense-experience without it:** The five sense-consciousnesses and mental consciousness arise and cease from moment to moment. Without a continuous underlying consciousness, there would be no basis for the arising of the operative consciousnesses.

3. **From the impossibility of seeds without it:** The seeds (*bīja*) of all dharmas must be stored somewhere. The six consciousnesses are too intermittent and too specific to serve as the universal repository of seeds.

4. **From the impossibility of karma-result without it:** Karma performed in one life must produce its result in a future life. Without the *ālaya-vijñāna* to carry the karmic seeds, this would be impossible.

5. **From the impossibility of mindless states without it:** In states such as the attainment of cessation, dreamless sleep, and fainting, the six consciousnesses cease. If there were no underlying consciousness, the body would be a corpse. The *ālaya-vijñāna* continues to function in these states.

6. **From the impossibility of death and rebirth without it:** At the time of death, consciousness departs the body. At the time of rebirth, consciousness enters a new body. The *ālaya-vijñāna* is the consciousness that performs these functions.

7. **From the impossibility of simultaneity without it:** Multiple consciousnesses operate simultaneously. The *ālaya-vijñāna* serves as the common foundation for their simultaneous operation.

8. **From the impossibility of purification without it:** The path purifies defilements progressively. This requires a continuous consciousness in which the seeds of defilement are stored and progressively eliminated.

The five-fold establishment of the *ālaya-vijñāna*:

1. **Object-domain (*ālambana*):** The *ālaya-vijñāna* takes as its object the seeds of all dharmas and the body with its sense-faculties.

2. **Concomitants (*samprayukta*):** It is always accompanied by the five omnipresent mental factors (attention, contact, feeling, perception, volition), but only with the neutral, indistinct feeling of neither pleasure nor suffering.

3. **Mutual causation:** The *ālaya-vijñāna* and the operative consciousnesses serve as mutual causes. The *ālaya-vijñāna* provides the seeds for the arising of the operative consciousnesses; the operative consciousnesses perfume the *ālaya-vijñāna* with new seeds.

4. **Simultaneous operation:** The *ālaya-vijñāna* operates simultaneously with one or more of the seven operative consciousnesses. At minimum, it always operates together with the afflicted mentation (*kliṣṭa-manas*); at maximum, all eight consciousnesses operate together.

5. **Defilement and purification:** The *ālaya-vijñāna* is the root of all defilement (*saṃkleśa*) because it stores and activates the seeds of affliction. It is also the basis for purification (*vyavadāna*) because the seeds of wholesome dharmas are also stored within it, and through cultivation of the path, the seeds of defilement are progressively eliminated and the *ālaya-vijñāna* itself is transformed.

Fascicle 18

Chapter 11: Compendium of Supreme Determinations (Continued, Part 2)

Supreme Determination on the Simultaneous Operation of Consciousnesses **Question:** How is the simultaneous operation of the consciousnesses established?

Answer: The *ālaya-vijñāna* may at one time operate together with only one operative consciousness, namely the mentation (*manas*). Why? Because this mentation is always conjoined with the activities of self-view, self-conceit, and similar afflictions, with an aspect of prideful elevation. Whether in states with mind or states without mind, it always arises simultaneously with this consciousness.

Moreover, this mentation always takes the *ālaya-vijñāna* as its object, and arises with the aspect of grasping ”I” and conceit.

At one time, the *ālaya-vijñāna* may operate together with two operative consciousnesses: mentation and mental consciousness. At one time, with three: when one of the five sense-consciousnesses arises along with the preceding two. At one time, with four: when two of the five sense-consciousnesses arise along with the preceding two. [As above], up to seven operative consciousnesses: when all five sense-consciousnesses arise together along with mentation and mental consciousness.

The *Ālaya-vijñāna* and Feelings The *ālaya-vijñāna* may at one time operate together with painful feeling, pleasant feeling, or neutral feeling. These feelings are associated with the operative consciousnesses and arise dependent on them, being generated from the seeds in the *ālaya-vijñāna*.

In the human realm, in the desire-realm heavens, and in portions of the ghost and animal realms, the innate neutral feeling associated with the *ālaya-vijñāna* operates simultaneously with the painful, pleasant, and neutral feelings associated with the operative consciousnesses.

In the hells, the neutral feeling is overwhelmed by others, and the *ālaya-vijñāna* operates simultaneously with the purely painful feelings of the operative consciousnesses. This feeling of the *ālaya-vijñāna*, being overwhelmed, is difficult to discern.

Just as in the hells it always operates with painful feeling, so in the lower three absorptions it always operates with pleasant feeling, and from the fourth absorption up through the peak of existence it always operates with neutral feeling.

Defilement and Purification Through the *Ālaya-vijñāna* **Question:** How is the aspect of defilement and purification of the *ālaya-vijñāna* established?

Answer: In brief, the *ālaya-vijñāna* should be known as the root of all defiled dharmas. Why? Because this *ālaya-vijñāna* is the root of the arising of the sentient-being world: it generates the sense-faculties, their supporting bases, and the operative consciousnesses. It is also the root of the arising of the vessel world: it generates the external environment. And this consciousness is also the root of the mutual arising of all sentient beings, because all sentient beings serve as dominant conditions (*adhipati-pratyaya*) for one another.

Furthermore, because the *ālaya-vijñāna* possesses the seeds of all things, in the present life it is the substance of the truth of suffering; it is the cause that generates the future truth of suffering; and it is also the cause that generates the present truth of origination. Thus it is the root of all defilement.

As for purification: the *ālaya-vijñāna* also holds the seeds of wholesome dharmas conducive to liberation (*mokṣa-bhāgīya*) and conducive to penetration (*nirvedha-bhāgīya*). These are not causes of the truth of origination, because the wholesome roots conducive to liberation oppose the flow of cyclic existence. Through cultivation of wholesome dharmas, these seeds become increasingly potent, and the wholesome dharmas they generate become increasingly clear and pure.

Through the cultivation of the path, practitioners who are ordinary beings first direct their attention toward the operative consciousnesses and cultivate calm abiding and insight. Before seeing the truths, one cannot penetrate the *ālaya-vijñāna* with its seeds. After entering the path of seeing, whether as a śrāvaka, pratyekabuddha, or bodhisattva, one penetrates the dharma-realm and thereby also penetrates the *ālaya-vijñāna*. At that point, one observes the totality of one's own internal defilement.

The practitioner, because the *ālaya-vijñāna* is the realm of all conceptual elaboration, gathers all those conditioned activities into the *ālaya-vijñāna* as a single mass, a single heap, a single aggregate. Having done so, through the wisdom that takes suchness (*tathatā*) as its object, by cultivating and repeatedly cultivating, the basis is transformed (*āśraya-parivṛtti*). Without interval, one should know that the *ālaya-vijñāna* has been severed. By this severance, all defilement has been severed.

This transformation of the basis (*āśraya-parivṛtti*) is opposed in nature to the *ālaya-vijñāna*: the *ālaya-vijñāna* is impermanent and has the character of appropriation; the transformation is permanent and has no character of appropriation. The *ālaya-vijñāna* is accompanied by heaviness (*dauṣṭhulya*); the ultimate transformation is utterly free from all heaviness. The *ālaya-vijñāna* is the cause of affliction-arising and the cause of non-arising of the noble path; the transformation is the cause of affliction-non-arising and the cause of arising of

the noble path.

When the *ālaya-vijñāna* is severed, one relinquishes two kinds of appropriation: future appropriation (because the cause of future suffering is severed) and present appropriation (because the cause of all present defilement is severed). The body, though still present, is like an illusion. Only the conditions of remaining lifespan sustain it. Therefore the Buddha said: ”At that time, one experiences only body-limit feeling and life-limit feeling.”

The Four-Fold Analysis of Mind and *Ālaya-vijñāna* **Question:** If one possesses the *ālaya-vijñāna*, does one also possess the operative consciousnesses? If one possesses the operative consciousnesses, does one also possess the *ālaya-vijñāna*?

Answer: This should be analyzed in four positions:

1. One possesses the *ālaya-vijñāna* but not the operative consciousnesses: those in dreamless sleep, in fainting, in the attainment of the thoughtless absorption, in the attainment of cessation, and those born in the thoughtless heaven.
2. One possesses the operative consciousnesses but not the *ālaya-vijñāna*: arhats, pratyekabuddhas, non-regressing bodhisattvas, and tathāgatas who are in states with mind.
3. One possesses both: all other beings in states with mind.
4. One possesses neither: arhats, pratyekabuddhas, non-regressing bodhisattvas, and tathāgatas who have entered the attainment of cessation, or who abide in the nirvāṇa-realm without remainder.

Supreme Determination on the Differentiation of Mind The differentiation of mind should be known through the following verse:

> By the power of support and object, The differentiation of mind is established. Further, by seven modes of activity, The hard-to-know aspects should be understood.

The differentiation of mind is established through the power of the support (*āśraya*, i.e., the sense-faculties) and the power of the object (*ālambana*). By the power of support, eye-consciousness through mental consciousness are established. By the power of the object, form-consciousness through dharma-consciousness are established, and further blue-consciousness, yellow-consciousness, through pain-consciousness and pleasure-consciousness.

Further, seven modes of activity reveal the hard-to-know differentiations of mind:

1. The imperceptible, long-continuing differentiation of the vessel world.
2. The differentiation of multiple objects.
3. The differentiation of coexistence.
4. The differentiation of the rapid alternation of antidote and affliction.
5. The differentiation of habitual tendencies.
6. The differentiation of continuation into rebirth.
7. The differentiation of the liberated mind.

Bondage of Mind As the verse says:

> Lacking autonomy over objects, Abiding in a defiled support, Turning according to the power of conditions: The bondage of mind should be known.

Mind is said to be bound for three reasons: (1) it lacks autonomy over its objects, (2) it abides in a defiled support, and (3) it turns according to the power of conditions.

Scattering and Settling of Mind Scattering of mind is of six kinds: (1) scattering through attention, (2) external scattering, (3) internal scattering, (4) scattering through characteristics, (5) scattering through heaviness, (6) natural scattering.

Settling of mind is of fifteen kinds, from the initial settling through the complete, sovereign, dynamic, still, supremely still, most supremely still, faith-based, decisive, image-based, reality-based, settling with over-estimation, settling without over-estimation, through the settling with threefold contamination.

Supreme Determination on Mental Factors As the verse says:

> Dependent on cognizing multiple objects, Each arises performing its own function. Mental factors should not be further questioned: They turn in relation to similar objects.

Mental factors (*caitasika*) arise dependent on the eight consciousnesses that cognize multiple objects, each performing its own specific function. They are designated ”mental factors” because they depend on mind and are associated with mind.

The five omnipresent mental factors perform these functions: attention (*manaskāra*) directs the mind; contact (*sparśa*) is the threefold conjunction that discriminates; feeling (*vedanā*) experiences the agreeable, disagreeable, or neutral condition; perception (*saṃjñā*) ascertains the distinguishing marks of the condition; and volition (*cetanā*) creates the activities of merit, demerit, or neither.

Supreme Determination on Form As the verse says:

> In the upper realms, no smell or taste; Great elements and derived form are found as appropriate. Atoms have no self-nature; Seven things are not ultimately real.

In the form and formless realms above the desire realm, smell and taste do not exist. The four great elements and their derived forms exist in each realm only to the extent that they are actually found there. Atoms (*paramāṇu*) are merely conceptual designations and have no real self-nature.

Seven things lack ultimate reality: (1) manifest form (*vijñapti-rūpa*), (2) shape, (3) shadow, (4) echo, (5) tangible derived form, (6) disciplinary form, (7) non-disciplinary form.

Furthermore:

> Atoms combine inseparably; Good and evil have no natural self-nature. Beyond the three characteristics, no other form exists; Form pertaining to the dharma-base is of twelve kinds.

The twelve kinds of form pertaining to the dharma-base (*dharma-āyatana-paryāpanna-rūpa*) include: (1) image form, (2) form produced by accomplishment, (3) invisible form, (4) non-resistant form, (5) form not born from real great elements, (6) form belonging to the mind, (7) worldly form, (8) inconceivable form, (9) worldly concentration-result form, (10) supramundane concentration-result form, (11) form of one's own and lower realms, (12) inconceivable form of buddhas' and bodhisattvas' autonomous transformation.

Supreme Determination on Formations Not Associated with Mind As the verse says:

> Know that non-associated formations Are all provisionally designated as existent. Provisional existence is of six kinds; Each has two faults.

All formations not associated with mind (*citta-viprayukta-saṃskāra*) are provisionally existent (*prajñapti-sat*). Six kinds of discourse indicate provisional existence:

1. **Discourse requiring attribution to a possessor:** For example, ”arising” must be attributed to a possessor (whose arising?), as in ”the arising of form,” ”the arising of feeling, perception, formations, consciousness.”
2. **Discourse remote from both 'this' and 'that':** Language that neither describes 'this' by 'this' nor 'that' by 'that' always pertains to provisional entities.
3. **Discourse of collective designation:** For example, designating ”I” based on form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness; or designating ”house” based on the arrangement of external materials.
4. **Discourse of aggregation:** Language applied to the combination of many things in one designation.
5. **Discourse not pervading all:** For example, the word ”house” applies in some cases but not in others (not to a village, a pavilion, etc.).
6. **Discourse of impermanence:** For example, when a pot breaks, the word ”pot” is abandoned and the word ”shards” arises.

All formations not associated with mind are proven to be merely provisional by two kinds of fault: (1) fault of cause, and (2) fault of substance. Fault of cause: if arising is said to be the cause of arising, then there is no separate fruit for it to produce. Fault of substance: if arising is itself a substance that arises from another, then it should not be called ”that which produces.”

Supreme Determination on Causes As the verse says:

> Three faults show that five of the six causes are untenable; The characteristics of cause: in brief, bondage and combination. By the distinctions of characteristics, basis, and differentiation, Multiple kinds of cause are established.

Certain non-Buddhist and Abhidharma schools posit six kinds of cause: (1) simultaneous cause (*sahabhū-hetu*), (2) homogeneous cause (*sabhāga-hetu*), (3) universal cause (*sarvatraga-hetu*), (4) associated cause (*samprayukta-hetu*), (5) maturation cause (*vipāka-hetu*), (6) efficient cause (*kāraṇa-hetu*). Except for the maturation cause, the other five are untenable due to three faults: the fault of redundancy, the fault of indeterminacy, and the fault of empty designation.

The correct establishment of causes recognizes two: (1) the cause characterized by bondage (*bandhana-lakṣaṇa-hetu*), referring to afflictive latent tendencies, spoken of with respect to generating future existence; and (2) the cause characterized by combination (*sāmagrī-lakṣaṇa-hetu*), referring to the combination of causes and conditions that generate phenomena in the present.

The characteristics of causation are: When by means of something as prior condition, something as foundation, and something as combination, various dharmas either arise, are obtained, are established, are accomplished, or perform their function, then that which serves as prior condition, foundation, and combination is said to be their cause.

Fifteen bases of causal dependence (*hetu-nimitta-āśraya*): (1) language, (2) reception, (3) habitual tendency, (4) moistened seed, (5) immediately preceding cessation, (6) object, (7) sense-faculty, (8) function, (9) personal effort, (10) true seeing, (11) conformity, (12) distinctive capacity, (13) combination, (14) obstruction, (15) non-obstruction.

Differentiation: Ten causes, four conditions, five fruits.

The **ten causes** are: (1) spoken-of cause (*abhilāpya-hetu*), (2) observing cause (*apekṣā-hetu*), (3) leading cause (*ākarṣaṇa-hetu*), (4) generative cause (*janana-hetu*), (5) supporting cause (*upastambha-hetu*), (6) developing cause (*abhinirvartana-hetu*), (7) determining cause (*pratiniyama-hetu*), (8) co-operative cause (*sahakāri-hetu*), (9) contrary cause (*viruddha-hetu*), (10) non-contrary cause (*aviruddha-hetu*).

The **four conditions** are: (1) causal condition (*hetu-pratyaya*), i.e., the seeds; (2) immediately preceding condition (*samanantara-pratyaya*), i.e., the immediately preceding cessation of a consciousness from which the next consciousness necessarily arises; (3) object condition (*ālambana-pratyaya*), i.e., the objects of mind and mental factors; (4) dominant condition (*adhipati-pratyaya*), i.e., all other supporting conditions.

The **five fruits** are: (1) maturation fruit (*vipāka-phala*), (2) outflow fruit (*niṣyanda-phala*), (3) separation fruit (*visaṃyoga-phala*), (4) person-produced fruit (*puruṣakāra-phala*), (5) dominant fruit (*adhipati-phala*).

The treatise then provides detailed establishment of each of the ten causes in terms of the fifteen bases, and the four conditions in terms of the bases, and the five fruits in terms of the bases.

Seven characteristics of causation: (1) Impermanent dharmas alone are causes; no permanent dharma can be a cause. (2) An impermanent dharma, when acting as a cause for another impermanent dharma, serves as the cause of another nature, not of its own nature, and also serves as the cause of its own later nature, not of the same moment. (3) When serving as a cause, it must be already arisen and not yet ceased, not un-arisen or already ceased. (4) When already arisen and not yet ceased, it must obtain the other conditions, not fail to obtain them. (5) When obtaining the other conditions, it must undergo transformation, not remain unchanged. (6) When undergoing transformation, it must have the appropriate capacity, not have lost its capacity. (7) When having the capacity, it must be suitable and concordant, not unsuitable and discordant.

Supreme Determination on Unconditioned Dharmas As the verse says:

> Because it is the object of mind, Because it is the object of purification, Because of four kinds of separation: Eight unconditioned dharmas are established.

Space as unconditioned is established because, as an object of mind, it resembles permanence, since the mind that takes it as object and its object-realm do not vary over time. Suchness (*tathatā*) is established as the object of purification, because at the time of purification, the nature of its object remains ever thus. The remaining four unconditioned dharmas are established through four kinds of separation: (1) separation through the absence of conditions, (2) ultimate separation through analytical elimination of afflictions, (3) temporary separation from suffering and pleasure, and (4) temporary separation of mind and mental factors.

Supreme Determination on Realms As the verse says:

> The three realms should be known Through twelve aspects of differentiation, As what is to be treated and what treats: Only the seeds are suppressed.

The three realms of desire, form, and formlessness are differentiated through twelve aspects: (1) variety, (2) destinies, (3) accompaniment by suffering, pleasure, or neutral feeling, (4) difficulty and ease, (5) purity and impurity of place and body, (6) modes of enjoyment, (7) superiority and inferiority of wholesome roots, (8) admixture with evil conduct, (9) thickness and thinness of heaviness, (10) modes of birth, (11) modes of obtaining a body, (12) modes of speech.

The desire realm is what is to be treated; the form realm treats it. The form realm is what is to be treated; the formless realm treats it. Lower grounds are treated by upper grounds. However, this treatment only suppresses the seeds, making them weak; it does not permanently destroy them, since they can arise again.

As the verse says:

> The dharma-king, the saltiness of the ocean, Longevity in evil destinies, and multiple worlds sharing one designation: Each has two causal reasons.

Why is Yama, king of the ghosts, called a ”dharma-king”? For two reasons: (1) he benefits those beings by causing them to recall their past actions and reproach their former evil deeds, and (2) he prevents them from creating further evil karma among the hell-wardens, so they can swiftly escape.

Why is the water of the great ocean all salty? For two reasons: (1) through the superior merit of water-born beings, other beings are prevented from entering, and (2) through the demerit of land-born beings, they are unable to enter and take the precious jewels.

Why do beings in the hells and among animals sometimes have very long lifespans, while beings in the desire realm's good destinies do not? For two reasons: (1) wholesome dharmas in the desire realm require deliberate effort to arise, and (2) unwholesome dharmas arise spontaneously without deliberation.

Why are the many worlds up to the Akaniṣṭha heaven called ”one world system” only up to the Brahma-world? For two reasons: (1) they are formed and destroyed together, and (2) they constitute the assembly.

Fascicle 19

Chapter 11: Compendium of Supreme Determinations (Continued, Part 3)

Supreme Determination on Affliction-Defilement The four afflictions always associated with the mentation (*manas*) pervade all states and co-arise with all tainted wholesome and other minds without contradiction. They are all innate (not arising from discriminative analysis), are of the morally indeterminate-but-obstructive (*nivṛta-avyākṛta*) category, and are severed all at once by the vajra-like concentration (*vajropama-samādhi*) at the very end of the path.

These four are: (1) ignorance (*avidyā*), (2) view of the self-collection (*satkāya-dṛṣṭi*), (3) conceit (*māna*), and (4) self-love (*ātma-sneha*).

Twenty modes of affliction-manifestation (*paryavasthāna*), including: (1) manifestation according to desire (for householders), (2) manifestation against desire (for renunciants), (3) without discernment (under bad teachers), (4) with discernment (under good teachers), (5) mutually predominant (for those of predominant craving, etc.), (6) all equal (for those of balanced dispositions), (7) thin (for those of thin dust), (8) external-gate manifestation (for those not yet free from desire), (9) internal-gate manifestation (for those freed from desire by worldly means), (10) predominant manifestation (for ordinary beings), (11) manifestation through loss of mindfulness (for those in training), (12) manifestation through discrimination (for those firmly attached), (13) innate manifestation (for those not firmly attached), (14) manifestation through examination (for those fond of examining), (15) involuntary manifestation (for those asleep), (16) voluntary manifestation (for those awake), (17) irremediable manifestation (for those without the nature of nirvāṇa), (18) remediable manifestation (for those with the nature of nirvāṇa), (19) manifestation through grasping at characteristics, (20) manifestation without grasping at characteristics.

Twenty conditions for affliction, including: pleasure, suffering, neutral feeling, desire, thought, contact, previous habituation, latent tendencies, not associating with good friends, not hearing the correct dharma, improper attention, non-faith, laziness, forgetfulness, scattering, non-discernment, heedlessness, the state of being an ordinary person, separation from desire, and rebirth.

Twenty kinds of latent tendency, twenty kinds of affliction-objects, and **twenty kinds of heaviness (*dauṣṭhulya*)** are also enumerated in detail. [These follow the same structural pattern as the twenty modes of manifestation and are presented systematically.]

Supreme Determination on Karma-Defilement As the verse says:

> Karma is volition and what is done with volition; Its distinctions are thirteen kinds. Its fruits are six, in three phases; Karma-certainty is of five kinds.

In brief, karma is of two kinds: volition (*cetanā*) and what is done with volition (*cetayitvā*). These have thirteen subdivisions: body-karma, speech-karma, mind-karma; disciplinary karma, non-disciplinary karma, neither; meritorious karma, non-meritorious karma, imperturbable karma; black karma with black result, white karma with white result, mixed karma with mixed result, and karma that is neither black nor white with no result, which puts an end to all karma.

Karma has six fruits (desirable, undesirable, pure, maturation, outflow, and dominant) and three phases (action phase, habitual-tendency phase, and fruit phase). Karma-certainty is of five kinds: certainty of present-life result, certainty of next-life result, certainty of later-life result, certainty of receiving a result, and certainty of performing the action.

Karma ripens in four orders of priority: first the heaviest, then the nearest, then the most habituated, then the earliest performed.

Karma becomes wholesome or unwholesome in dependence on two roots: wholesome roots and unwholesome roots. The differentiation of wholesome and unwholesome karma should be understood through nine factors: (1) cause and field, (2) the object, (3) the means, (4) the support, (5) the mental attitude, (6) the aspiration, (7) the accompaniment, (8) repeated practice, (9) the number of persons involved.

Supreme Determination on Birth-Defilement As the verse says:

> Death may be definite or indefinite; Premature death has six causes. At the lucid stage, three kinds of mind; The intermediate state may or may not exist.

There are two kinds of death: definite (as in Uttarakuru, where lifespan is fixed) and indefinite (in other places). Premature death arises from six causes: (1) not avoiding imbalance, (2) loss of mindfulness, (3) mental anger and resentment, (4) exhaustion of lifespan, (5) exhaustion of karma, (6) exhaustion of merit.

At the time of death, during the lucid phase, three kinds of mind may arise: wholesome, unwholesome, or neutral. When the lucid phase passes into the non-lucid phase, only neutral mind remains.

After death, there may or may not be an intermediate state (*antarā-bhava*): for those about to be reborn in the form realm, there is an intermediate state; for those about to be reborn in the formless realm, there is no intermediate state.

Dependent on the intermediate state, with the place of rebirth as its object, a defiled mind arises and causes the continuity of existence. Rebirth occurs in the four modes of birth and across the three realms and five destinies.

Supreme Determination on Truths As the verse says:

> Know that conventional truth Is meaning understood through intention, and speech. The object of purification, its nature, And the means: these are called ultimate truth.

All speech and the meaning obtained through the intention caused by speech are called conventional truth. The object of purification (the four noble truths and suchness), the nature of purification (the truth of cessation), and the means of purification (the truth of the path) are called ultimate truth.

The four truths are encompassed by defilement and purification: two pertain to the defiled side (suffering as the fruit, origination as the cause) and two to the pure side (cessation as the fruit, the path as the cause). Like disease, the cause of disease, the cure, and the cause of the cure, the four truths are established.

Each of the four truths has four characteristics and four contemplation-aspects. The truths have the functions of full understanding (*parijñā*), abandonment (*prahāṇa*), direct realization (*sākṣātkriyā*), and cultivation (*bhāvanā*). The first three are the fruits; cultivation is the cause.

Conventional and ultimate truth are both called ”truth” because: in the case of conventional truth, the cognition of worldly beings accords with it without conflict, by the nature of things; in the case of ultimate truth, those who have seen the truths verify it without conflict, as it truly is. Therefore the Bhagavān said: ”All noble ones take this as truth; hence it is called noble truth.”

Supreme Determination on Meditative Bases As the verse says:

> Know the seven meditative bases Through three kinds of support-nature. Skill therein is of two kinds; The four-fold analysis and other topics are explained in detail.

The seven kinds of meditative base (*samāpatti*) serve three kinds of support: (1) as the support for the exhaustion of defilements, (2) as the support for the generation of virtues, (3) as the support for present happiness.

Two kinds of skill: (1) skill in *samādhi*, and (2) skill in *samāpatti*. These are analyzed in a four-fold scheme: one may be skilled in *samādhi* but not *samāpatti*, or the reverse, or both, or neither.

Various aspects of concentration are then treated in question-and-answer format: how one abides in concentration, how one emerges from it, the modes of practice, the signs of concentration, the objects, the characteristics of tranquility (*śamatha*), the modes of apprehension and relinquishment, and the conditions of increase and decrease.

Supreme Determination on the Four Absorptions As the verse says:

> The number of absorptions, their obstructions and branches, Their detailed establishment, Their removal of suffering and agitation: Each successive one surpasses the former.

Why are there exactly four absorptions and no more? Because the transcendence of suffering and pleasure is complete by the fourth.

Obstructions of the first absorption (five): (1) craving, aversion, and harmful thought, (2) suffering, (3) worry, (4) transgression of moral discipline, (5) scattering.

Obstructions of the second absorption (five): (1) craving for the first absorption, (2) applied and sustained thought, (3) suffering, (4) restlessness, (5) inferiority of the concentration.

Obstructions of the third absorption (four): (1) craving for the second absorption, (2) joy, (3) elation, (4) inferiority of the concentration.

Obstructions of the fourth absorption (five): (1) inhalation and exhalation, (2) craving for the third absorption, (3) pleasure, (4) attention to pleasure, (5) inferiority of the concentration.

Branches of the absorptions: The first has five (applied thought, sustained thought, joy, pleasure, one-pointedness). The second has four (inner clarity, joy, pleasure, one-pointedness). The third has five (mindfulness, clear comprehension, equanimity, pleasure, one-pointedness). The fourth has four (purity of equanimity, purity of mindfulness, neither-pleasure-nor-suffering, one-pointedness).

The second absorption surpasses the first through the perfection of concentration. The third surpasses the second through the perfection of benefit. The fourth surpasses the third through the perfection of purity.

The preliminary concentration (*sāmantaka*) of the first absorption alone can exhaust the defilements, not the others. The preliminary of the first absorption is of two kinds: worldly and supramundane. The other preliminaries are worldly only.

Eight attainments relinquish eight things: Relinquishing speech, applied thought, joy, and pleasure leads to the four absorption attainments. Relinquishing the perceptions of form, infinite space, infinite consciousness, and nothingness leads to the four formless attainments.

Retreat from concentration arises through multiple causes, including: physical imbalance, encounter with excellent objects, receiving honors, being criticized, conceit, over-estimation, failure to attend to the practice, lack of mastery, predominance of one's own afflictions, and exhaustion of lifespan, merit, or karma.

Among those with dull faculties and strong afflictions, retreat is swift and regaining concentration is slow. Among those with sharp faculties and weak afflictions, retreat is slow and regaining is swift. [The other two combinations follow accordingly.] Those with truly sharp faculties never retreat at all.

Supreme Determination on Awakening Factors As the verse says:

> Based on the two vehicles and the great vehicle, Through twenty-seven aspects of correct endeavor, The establishment of the awakening factors should be known.

The awakening factors are established based on the two vehicles (śrāvaka and pratyekabuddha) and the great vehicle (bodhisattva), through twenty-seven kinds of correct endeavor. These include: binding to the object of correct observation, relinquishing defilement and gathering purity, training and harmonizing the inner mind, generating supramundane dharmas, maintaining them without interruption, directly realizing the truth, and many others specific to the bodhisattva path (such as maturing sentient beings, accumulating merit, generating eloquence, and establishing beings in nirvāṇa).

The four foundations of mindfulness (*smṛty-upasthāna*) in detail:

Body, feeling, mind, and dharmas each have three aspects: for example, the body may be naturally impure (internal organs), apparently clean (the skin), or impure through transformation (a corpse). Feeling has three aspects: painful, pleasant, and neutral. Mind has three aspects corresponding to the three types of feeling. Dharmas have three aspects: dark, white, and mixed.

The observation of these foundations involves the use of images (*pratibimba*): one observes an image that is similar to the object, classified as the object of the three kinds of wisdom (wisdom born of hearing, thinking, and cultivation). Through the power of mindfulness, one abides without confusion regarding the teachings heard.

Nine obstructions to the foundations of mindfulness: (1) non-renunciation, (2) non-attention, (3) secondary afflictions of calm and insight, (4) sinking, (5) inability to endure, (6) contentment with little, (7) forgetting instructions, (8) transgressing discipline, (9) abandoning the yoke of practice.

Two kinds of attention in cultivating the foundations: non-lax attention and non-defiled attention. The expression ”ardently” in the sūtra indicates the first; ”with clear comprehension and mindfulness, removing worldly craving and grief” indicates the second, which removes three kinds of defilement: (1) regret arising from moral transgression (obstructing initial concentration), (2) inner torpor (causing loss of the object after concentration is attained), (3) external scattering (attachment to worldly fame and gain after attaining higher dharmas).

The practice of the paired path for overcoming sinking and restlessness is explained with reference to the *Bhikṣuṇī Sūtra* and the *Sūtra on Grasping One's Own Mental Sign*. When the mind sinks, one should contemplate a slightly pleasant, pure sign. When the mind is restless, one should gather the mind inward. Through alternation of these two, one severs the secondary afflictions of sinking and restlessness and attains correct concentration.

The passage from the *Quail Sūtra* is cited: the quail represents the practitioner's mind. Its unfit range represents contemplating desirable objects. Being seized by the hawk represents being seized by craving. The quail's lament represents regret. The temporary release represents the temporary cessation of craving. The clod of earth represents the five aggregates of clinging. The great field represents the contemplation of impermanence. The burrow represents the contemplation of suchness. Calling the hawk represents the attention of examination. The hawk's swift approach represents craving about to manifest. Entering the burrow represents contemplating suchness. The hawk harming itself represents the cutting of latent tendencies.

This paired path also exhausts three kinds of craving: craving for companions, craving for gain, and craving for future existence.

The foundations of mindfulness are also cultivated to counteract over-estimation, to counteract the defiled absorption that is the basis of relishing, and to counteract the four inversions (grasping the impermanent as permanent, the suffering as pleasant, the selfless as self, the impure as pure).

Three mental orientations for cultivation: when walking through a village, the mind tends toward renunciation; when dwelling in a busy place, the mind tends toward seclusion; when dwelling in a quiet room, the mind tends toward nirvāṇa.

Fascicle 20

Chapter 11: Compendium of Supreme Determinations (Continued, Part 4)

Supreme Determination on Persons As the verse says:

> Through distinctions of faculties and such, Five sets of twos are established. Persons are provisionally designated by five factors; Completeness is established through three things.

Through distinctions of faculties, five sets of twos are established: two faculties give rise to two kinds of attention; two kinds of attention give rise to two kinds of cultivation; two kinds of cultivation give rise to two kinds of conduct; two kinds of conduct give rise to two kinds of persons.

Persons are provisionally designated by five factors: (1) spiritual lineage (*gotra*), (2) mode of entry, (3) training, (4) attainment, (5) faults and virtues.

Three things constitute completeness: (1) completeness of faculties (the immovable type), (2) completeness of concentration (attaining the cessation attainment), (3) completeness of fruit (arhatship).

Supreme Determination on Fruits As the verse says:

> Attaining the transformation of the basis, non-arising, Two reasons why fruit has no regression, Three reasons why cessation is permanent, Three fruits and three reasons for the Buddha's prediction.

By attaining the transformation of the basis (*āśraya-parivṛtti*), the afflictions do not arise; this transformation is called ”cessation.” Fruit has no regression for two reasons: (1) it is unreasonable that one who has

not permanently destroyed the seeds of affliction should attain arhatship, and (2) one who has permanently destroyed the seeds of affliction cannot have afflictions arise again, since their seed-cause is absent.

Cessation is permanent for three reasons: (1) it is free from conceptual elaboration, and whatever is conceptual elaboration is seen to be impermanent; (2) it is revealed by purified suchness, like the malleability of refined gold; (3) the non-arising nature of afflictions does not differ between earlier and later.

Three fruits receive the Buddha's prediction for three reasons: (1) the stream-enterer receives prediction based on attainment of the four verified purities of the path of seeing; (2) the once-returner receives prediction based on joy, having begun to attain the fundamental absorption and experienced some joy; (3) the non-returner receives prediction based on recollection, having attained the fundamental absorption and directly seeing the assemblies of gods conversing with Brahmā, and recollecting that the virtues of their own vehicle are not yet complete.

Supreme Determination on Virtues As the verse says:

> The establishment of virtues Is through seventeen kinds of predominance. Their distinctions are boundless Because of the antidotes and what they antidote.

Virtues are established through seventeen kinds of predominant power:

1. Through the predominance of compassion for sentient beings: the four immeasurables (*apramāṇa*).
2. Through the predominance of the purification of six obstructions: the liberations (*vimokṣa*), bases of mastery (*abhibhv-āyatana*), and totalities (*kṛtsnāyatana*).
3. Through the predominance of knowing the right time to go: the quality of non-contention (*araṇā*).
4. Through the predominance of investigating the knowable: the knowledge of aspiration (*praṇidhi-jñāna*).
5. Through the predominance of verbal instruction: the four analytical knowledges (*pratisaṃvid*).
6. Through the predominance of skill in six areas: the six superknowledges (*abhijñā*).
7. Through the predominance of others' faith: the marks and signs.
8. Through the predominance of purification of three obstructions: the four kinds of complete purity.
9. Through the predominance of answering all questions: the powers (*bala*).
10. Through the predominance of defeating all opposing theories: the fearlessnesses (*vaiśāradya*).
11. Through the predominance of impartiality toward one's assembly: the three kinds of non-guardedness.
12. Through the predominance of training one's retinue: the three foundations of mindfulness.
13. Through the predominance of manifesting omniscient activity at all times: the permanent uprooting of habitual tendencies.
14. Through the predominance of not missing the right time for those to be trained: never-forgetting dharma.
15. Through the predominance of surveying the world six times day and night: great compassion.
16. Through the predominance of surpassing śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas: the eighteen unshared buddha-dharmas.
17. Through the predominance of accomplishing all the activities of the tathāgatas: omniscient wisdom of all modes.

These virtues have boundless distinctions because of the various antidotes and what they antidote.

The virtues should be contemplated in terms of: meaning, benefit, suffering, mental attention, abiding, difficulty, characteristics, and the special and non-special.

Contemplation of meaning: The meaning of the perfection of wisdom (*prajñāpāramitā*) is summarized in five purposes: (1) generating respect for the speaker, (2) gathering the assembly, (3) generating respect for

the verbal teaching, (4) narrating the subject matter, (5) generating much activity regarding the true meaning.

All dharmas have three kinds of meaning: the superimposed meaning, the superimposed-upon meaning, and the meaning of dharma-nature. Just as form has three aspects (the superimposed form, the superimposed-upon form, and the dharma-nature of form), so for all dharmas.

There is also the three-wheel mode of discourse: according to conventional truth, one speaks of agent, instrument, and action. For example, the giver, the act of giving, and the recipient.

Four kinds of doctrinal discourse: (1) discourse on distinction, (2) discourse on establishment, (3) discourse on non-difference, and (4) discourse on non-function. These encompass the full range of the Buddha's teaching methods.

Two kinds of immeasurable meaning, three kinds of signless meaning, three kinds of the meaning of apprehension, five kinds of incorrect apprehension, four kinds of verbal teaching, two kinds of what emptiness antidotes, two kinds of perfection practice (worldly with apprehension, and supramundane without apprehension).

The self-nature of the perfection of wisdom has three aspects: (1) its support (*āśraya*), which is the mind of awakening; (2) its object (*ālambana*), which is dharmas such as form; (3) its mode (*ākāra*), which is twofold: worldly (contemplating impermanence, suffering, emptiness, no-self, like disease, like a boil, etc.) and supramundane (the mode conjoined with non-apprehension).

Three kinds of excellent accumulation of the perfections: (1) with the intention conjoined with omniscient knowledge, dedicating merit to all sentient beings for supreme perfect awakening; (2) through the perfections, abiding in the true limit (*bhūta-koṭi*); (3) abiding in the true limit without realizing it prematurely.

The inconceivability of the mind: The mind is inconceivable because of its support, its object, and the fact that in which it abides: all of these are without self-nature. If they are without self-nature, they are pure, and purity too is inconceivable.

Three causes of mind's wandering: (1) through proximity (holding the support at the time of receiving a result), (2) through objects (experiencing various objects and engaging in various activities), (3) through establishment (the beginningless habitual perfuming of false imagination).

Supreme Determination on the Great Vehicle As the verse says:

> Spiritual lineage, the Tathāgata's teaching, Many buddhas and the one vehicle: By five, ten, six, and six kinds of reasoning, respectively.

Five reasons establishing the differentiation of spiritual lineage (*gotra*): (1) the differentiation of all realms of sentient beings is observable, (2) a being without any faculty is unreasonable, (3) the analogy of transferable class (like caste) is inapplicable, (4) the analogy of transferable substance (like gold becoming iron) is inapplicable, (5) the assertion that one without the nirvāṇa-nature in this life might have it in another is unreasonable.

Ten reasons proving that the Mahāyāna teaching is the Buddha's word: (1) it was not previously predicted that another would speak it, (2) it cannot be known to be from another, (3) it accomplishes much, (4) the obstructions are extremely heavy, (5) it is not the domain of discursive thought, (6) it is attained through supreme awakening, (7) without it, there would be the fault of no third vehicle, (8) without it, there would be no omniscient one, (9) taking it as object and reflecting properly antidotes all afflictions, (10) it should not be taken literally.

Six reasons proving that many tathāgatas can appear simultaneously: (1) innumerable beings simultaneously generate the aspiration for great awakening, (2) innumerable beings simultaneously cultivate the requisites of awakening, (3) mutual obstruction is unreasonable, (4) simultaneous completion and emergence is reasonable, (5) sequential emergence alone is unreasonable, (6) ultimate non-accomplishment would follow.

Six reasons why the Tathāgata taught the one vehicle (*ekayāna*): (1) speaking of the non-differentiated aspect of those very dharmas, (2) speaking of the non-discriminating mode of practice, (3) the equality of person-selflessness and dharma-selflessness, (4) the equality of liberation, (5) skillful abiding through transformation, (6) the ultimate nature of practice.

All tathāgatas are equal in their capacity for all activities. Their fruits, the purification of buddha-lands, the liberation-body, and the dharma-body are equal, inconceivable, and unsurpassed for all buddhas.

Based on the unconditioned dharma-body, though without deliberate effort, through the power of prior vows, all the tathāgatas' buddha-activities arise spontaneously, like a practitioner emerging from the cessation attainment. These buddha-activities are of an inexhaustible nature, neither of the character of cyclic existence nor of nirvāṇa.

The Three Baskets Question: What is the Sūtra-piṭaka? What is the Vinaya-piṭaka? What is the Abhidharma-piṭaka (Mātṛkā)?

Answer:

The **Sūtra-piṭaka** (*sūtra-piṭaka*) is where the Bhagavān exclusively disclosed dharmas based on the compendium of topics. These topics are of three levels: four topics, nine topics, and twenty-nine topics.

The four topics are: (1) the topic of hearing, (2) the topic of refuge, (3) the topic of training, (4) the topic of awakening.

The nine topics are: (1) the topic of provisionally designated sentient beings, (2) the topic of their enjoyments, (3) the topic of their arising, (4) the topic of their continued existence after arising, (5) the topic of their defilement and purification, (6) the topic of their various distinctions, (7) the topic of the speaker, (8) the topic of the dharma spoken, (9) the topic of the assembly.

The twenty-nine topics are distributed between the defiled side (four topics on the aggregates, their sequential turning, the establishment of beings' conceptions as causes of subsequent turning, and the establishment of dharma-conceptions as causes of subsequent turning) and the pure side (twenty-five topics including settling on the object, exertion therein, settling of mind, present happiness, the object and means for transcending all suffering, three kinds of full understanding, the basis of cultivation, realization, practice, its stabilization, its mode, its object, skill in observing what is abandoned and what is not, scattering, non-scattering, the basis of non-scattering, unwearied cultivation, the benefits of cultivation, its stabilization, the assemblage of the noble, what the noble assemblage abandons, true penetration, realization of nirvāṇa, the worldly right view obtained in the well-taught dharma that surpasses all external right views, and the regression that comes from not cultivating this).

The **Vinaya-piṭaka** (*vinaya-piṭaka*) is where the Bhagavān taught the rules of individual liberation (*prātimokṣa*) for śrāvakas and bodhisattvas, along with detailed explanations. The bodhisattva's individual liberation is summarized in seven aspects: (1) declaring the manner of receiving the discipline, (2) declaring the matters that constitute defeat, (3) declaring the matters of transgression, (4) declaring the nature of transgression, (5) declaring the nature of non-transgression, (6) declaring the manner of emergence from transgression, (7) declaring the manner of relinquishing the discipline.

The **Mātṛkā** (*Abhidharma-piṭaka*) is where the Bhagavān disclosed and analyzed dharmas through eleven aspects: (1) the conventional-truth aspect, (2) the ultimate-truth aspect, (3) the object-aspect of the factors of awakening, (4) the mode-aspect, (5) the self-nature aspect, (6) the fruit-aspect, (7) the experience-and-disclosure aspect, (8) the obstruction-aspect, (9) the accordance-aspect, (10) the fault-aspect, (11) the praise-aspect.

The mode-aspect includes eight kinds of examination: (1) examination of truth, (2) examination of establishment, (3) examination of faults, (4) examination of virtues, (5) examination of doctrinal approach, (6) examination of cyclic existence, (7) examination of reasoning, (8) examination of the concise and the extensive.

The reasoning-aspect includes four kinds of reasoning: (1) reasoning of dependence (*apekṣā-yukti*), (2) reasoning of function (*kārya-karaṇa-yukti*), (3) reasoning of proof (*upapatti-sādhana-yukti*), (4) reasoning of the nature of things (*dharmatā-yukti*).

The reasoning of proof has two kinds: pure and impure. Pure proof has five aspects: (1) directly perceived, (2) based on what is directly perceived, (3) drawing analogies of the same class, (4) established, (5) pure verbal testimony. Impure proof has seven aspects: (1) partially similar, (2) partially dissimilar, (3) entirely similar, (4) entirely dissimilar, (5) drawing analogies of a different class, (6) unestablished, (7) impure verbal testimony.

Five aspects identify a true omniscient one: (1) the fame of an omniscient one appearing in the world is current, (2) he possesses the thirty-two marks of a great being, (3) he possesses the ten powers and resolves all beings' doubts, (4) he claims the four fearlessnesses without being defeated by any opponent's argument and can refute all external theories, (5) in his dharma-vinaya, the noble eightfold path and the four fruits of the renunciant are found.

Summary of the Sūtras As the verse says:

> Characteristics and cessation, The means without degeneration, The fruits of both, and distinctions: These are the summary meaning of the sūtras.

The summary meaning of the sūtras has five aspects: (1) characteristics, (2) cessation, (3) the means without degeneration, (4) the fruits of both, and (5) the distinctions among types of quiescence. The five kinds of quiescence are: quiescence of entanglements, worldly quiescence of separation from desire, quiescence of the lower fetters, quiescence of the upper fetters, and quiescence of the basis.

As the verse in the sūtra states:

> ”Monks who are beautiful, quiescent, free from defilements, Free from desire, free from bondage, Without appropriation, in nirvāṇa, Bearing their final body, defeating Māra's armies.”

Summary of the Yoga Path As the final verse says:

> In brief, the yoga path Takes the correctly heard dharma as its object. Calm abiding and insight, Based on images, lead to accomplishment.

In brief, the yoga path should be known as follows: the correctly heard dharma is its object, calm abiding (*śamatha*) and insight (*vipaśyanā*) are its essence, and it relies on images (*pratibimba*) and on actual accomplishment (*siddhi*).

As the Bhagavān said: ”There are five dharmas that encompass all the grounds of yoga for all yoga practitioners: (1) retention (*dhāraṇā*), (2) abiding (*sthiti*), (3) illumination (*āloka*), (4) mirror (*ādarśa*), and (5)

transformation of the basis (*āśraya-parivṛtti*)."

The correctly heard dharma is retention. The object is abiding. Calm abiding and insight are illumination. The image is the mirror. Actual accomplishment is the transformation of the basis.

End of the Xiǎnyáng Shèngjiào Lùn, Taishō No. 1602, in twenty fascicles.